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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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General Comment

I am writing to call for existing copyright laws to be enforced, and to insist that copyright laws must not be weakened for the use of so-called "artificial intelligence" or "AI", as many large corporations want.

Generative "AI", which is not actually intelligent at all, artificially or not, is a dangerous technology whose current use in the arts & entertainment fields is largely unethical and immoral. Its uses should be well regulated to protect people and their copyright. Generative "AI" does not function at all without being fed vast amounts of training data. This training data is comprised of countless works of art created by real people, the vast majority of whom DID NOT CONSENT to having their work used in the training data. Such people were also not compensated.

Big corporations like Google are demanding that copyright law be weakened to allow them and other large companies to ignore the copyrights of real people, so that the corporations can steal peoples images, writings, audio, movies, shows, games, & other forms of media and use it as training data for generative "AI". These corporations falsely claim that it is in the interest of national security that they be given exemptions to copyright law when it comes to "AI". It has nothing to do with national security, and everything to do with greed. The corporations do not want to respect the copyrights of millions of individuals. They do not want to have to ask for permission to use peoples creations, or to be required to compensate them financially. Google and others want to be able to make a fortune off of other peoples work without paying them anything for it. This would amount to the largest theft of peoples property in history.

The big corporations have already stolen the artwork of millions of people over the last several years for use in the training data of their "AI" models, and they are now facing lawsuits over it. They know that they've violated the law, and that eventually they will lose in court and have to pay immense fines. They don't want to play by the rules though, and so now they are asking the government to change the law and bail them out of court. This is disgusting and must not be allowed. It would cause irreversible damage to countless people, myself included. Ironically, if corporations like Google succeed in having exemptions carved out in copyright law for their "AI" usage, they themselves will end up having their own corporate copyrights violated by both individuals and other rival corporations. All anyone will need to do is claim they are stealing Mickey Mouse from Disney for "AI" training purposes, and they will be immune from lawsuits. It goes both ways here.

I hereby make it known that I, as an artist, DO NOT consent to anything I create being used as training data by any form of "AI", for any reason. The copyrights that I own now and in the future, along with the copyrights held by other people and corporations now and in the future, must be protected from being abused and stolen for use in "AI".